

THE LAST FIVE YEARS · THE SECOND SCREEN

The Cue Bible

build-2026-09-18 · line-by-line

72 cues · 14 songs · generated from the live show build, so this document cannot drift from what the phones actually do

THE STANDING RULE: the phone behaves exactly like a real phone. Tapping a notification IS the unlock — the app opens directly, no home screen. Inboxes and message lists load whole the instant the app opens, and a full life continues past the bottom edge of the glass. Only what would genuinely arrive right now — a text, a notification, new mail — appears live, and new mail lands at the top. Anything that violates this is a bug, even if it would make a nice theatrical beat.

How to read each entry: the header gives the cue ID, which screen, whose phone, the app, and the musical anchor. ON SCREEN is the complete content, verbatim and untruncated. PLAYS covers mechanics the engine performs on its own — navigation, self-timed animation, synthesized sound. PHONES gives the state after the cue when it changed. Gold notes carry dramaturgy, holds, and open director choices.

1 · Still Hurting CATHY SINGS · 6 FIRES

COLD OPEN. Her phone is the first actor on stage. The house learns the grammar wordlessly: a notification is tapped and the app is simply there; a list is already full; only what would truly arrive live ever arrives live. When she puts the phone down, the memories go full-bleed — non-diegetic, the frame gone.

1.1 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — *PROLOGUE* — *the first note of the wedding waltz. SHE is discovered on her phone.*

AUTO-PLAYS from this one GO (~25 s). Her phone, lit — JUNE 2026, the morning after. Facebook pushes a Memories notification; she gives in and taps it; four cards scroll up one at a time — 2025 Ohio (the card he is not in), 2024 the wedding, 2023 the ring, 2022 the couch. Nothing else to fire until the first bar.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “JUNE 2026”

LOCK CLOCK — 9:41 · Friday, June 12, 2026

WALLPAPER — M24 — cast photo of JAMIE — she never changed it

... a beat (auto-timed, 2.6 s)

NOTIFICATION — Facebook · Memories (now): “You have memories with Jamie Wellerstein to look back on today”

... a beat (auto-timed, 2.2 s)

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.4 s)

MEMORY CARD — 1 year ago · 2025 — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12, 2025

post: “Ohio, round two. day one 🍷”

media: M2 — Ohio cast photo, day one — no Jamie

reactions: 🍷 31

... a beat (auto-timed, 2.4 s)

MEMORY CARD — 2 years ago · 2024 — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12, 2024

post: “married three weeks and 600 miles apart. worth it.”

media: M4 — the wedding portrait

reactions: 🍷 402

... a beat (auto-timed, 2.4 s)

MEMORY CARD — 3 years ago · 2023 — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12, 2023

post: “he asked. I said yes before he finished 💍”

media: M3a — the ring, the rowboat

reactions: 🍷 341

... a beat (auto-timed, 2.4 s)

MEMORY CARD — 4 years ago · 2022 — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12, 2022

post: “nine months in and our apartment has a name. it is called The Couch.”

media: M15 — the hideous couch

reactions: 🍷 88

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

sound: receive ding

TAP THE NOTIFICATION — a beat on the banner, Face ID passes, and the app opens DIRECTLY onto Facebook Memories. One motion. No home screen. (No touch dot anywhere in the show — cut by direction; the screen’s own feedback carries every tap.) the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

tap thock

PHONES SR = Facebook Memories · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

HOLD · *The card timings are the `pause` values in cues.js — stretch or tighten them to the waltz in tech.*

1.2 SR · CATHY — *FIRST BAR OF STILL HURTING* — *the downbeat, before she sings*

She puts the phone down. Black — JUNE 2026 holds center-stage while she sings.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK – the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

1.3 SR · CATHY · Messages — INTERLUDE (m. 58) — the bar after “...like it’s right”. She picks the phone back up.

AUTO-PLAYS from this GO (~12 s). Unlock, Messages — the whole list is condolences — his thread, mid-history: days of her asking, all Delivered, all silent. She types it live, hesitant, and SENDS. Delivered.

ON SCREEN

MESSAGES LIST — loads whole, already full:

- Mom ❤️ • — “call me when you’re up. I love you.” (8:02 AM)
- Dana + girls 🍷 • — “Dana: we’re coming over at 7. non-negotiable.” (7:41 AM)
- Beth — “just heard. I’m so so sorry 💔” (Yesterday)
- Grammy • — “sweetheart. are you eating?” (Yesterday)
- Aunt Patti — “your mother told me. call me, honey” (Yesterday)
- Jamie — “I’m not angry. just talk to me” (Wednesday)
- Michael (voice) — “no lesson this week — I’m out of town” (Tuesday)
- Ohio Housing — “Re: summer sublet — deposit received” (Monday)
- CVS Pharmacy — “Your prescription is ready for pickup” (Monday)
- Dentist — Dr. Okafor — “Reminder: cleaning Jun 22, 2:30 PM” (Sunday)

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.7 s)

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— May 12 · 6:40 PM

SENT (blue): “your mail is piling up here”

RECEIVED (gray): “I’ll come by this week”

SENT (blue): “ok”

— May 30 · 9:12 PM

SENT (blue): “the super needs to know about the lease by the 15th”

— Monday · 11:02 PM

SENT (blue): “are you coming home this weekend?”

— Wednesday · 8:15 AM

SENT (blue): “please just call me”

— Wednesday · 9:30 PM

SENT (blue): “I’m not angry. just talk to me”

status: Delivered

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.6 s)

thread caption: Today · 9:41 AM

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “I’m not sure that I can do this without you”

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.3 s)

SEND — the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

delivery status: Delivered

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — the list is already full; the last rows cut off at the bottom of the glass

HESITATION — “Jamie” holds the iOS pressed-gray under a resting finger ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

TAP COMMITS — the pressed row releases and pushes through · sound: tap

thread pushes in from the list — Jamie

sound: key clicks

sound: send swoosh

SOUND

unlock swish

send whoosh

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

HOLD · *Nothing to fire until her next sung line. If the interlude runs long, the Delivered sits — let it.*

1.4 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — “Give me a day, Jamie!” — *the memories return, full screen*

NON-DIEGETIC — she is not holding the phone. The frame drops away and the feed fills the whole screen, resting on the wedding card.

PLAYS

the full shell appears — CATHY’s screen

cut to Facebook Memories (instant)

PHONES SR = Facebook Memories · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

1.5 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — “Jamie is over and where can I turn?” — *the last verse*

The feed drifts down to the oldest card — nine months in, the couch, the happiest one — enormous, to close the song.

1.6 SR · CATHY — *FINAL CUTOFF* — *the last chord of Still Hurting*

Black on the cutoff. JUNE 2026 holds center-stage until his song rolls it back.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

2 · Shiksa Goddess **JAMIE SINGS · 10 FIRES**

THE FIRST NIGHT, FROM HIS SIDE. Three overwrought drafts die under the backspace key before two words survive: “home safe?” — the exact text the finale receives five years later. She answers by calling instead. His hesitation here is the measure for how fast he moves in 13.

2.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *TOP OF SHIKSA GODDESS — the first chord, as he enters*

HIS phone — time rolls BACK five years, JUNE 2026 → SEPTEMBER 2021. Locked, walking home: three unread on the lock screen, her number on top.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 11:38 · Friday, September 3, 2021

STAMP → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Mom ❤️ (3h ago): “dinner sunday. no excuses.”

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Rob (1h ago): “well??? how’d it go”

NOTIFICATION — Messages · +1 (917) 555-0148 (56m ago): “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:38

2.2 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *“I’m breaking my mother’s heart” — THE SECOND TIME*

The phone comes out. Unlock, straight to Messages — her number sits on top, one hour old.

ON SCREEN

MESSAGES LIST — loads whole, already full:

- +1 (917) 555-0148 • — “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight” (10:42 PM)
- Rob • — “well??? how’d it go” (10:12 PM)
- Mom ❤️ • — “dinner sunday. no excuses.” (8:05 PM)
- Dr. Adler — “gave your name to an agent — Ms. Whitfield. call her office.” (Yesterday)
- Elissa Weiss — “it was fun, but...” (Tuesday)
- H. Greenblatt — “ok. good luck with the book I guess” (Monday)
- S. Rosen — “I’ll call you this week” (2 wks ago)
- Columbia workshop — “Adam: notes attached for Thursday” (2 wks ago)

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — the list is already full; the last rows cut off at the bottom of the glass

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:38

2.3 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “The JCC of Spring Valley...” — the first draft

Her thread — one message in it: her number. He types a long, overwrought draft in full.

ON SCREEN

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 10:42 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight”

LOCK CLOCK — 11:39

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “Tonight was maybe the best night of my whole life”

PLAYS

HESITATION — “+1 (917) 555-0148” holds the iOS pressed-gray under a resting finger ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

TAP COMMITS — the pressed row releases and pushes through · sound: tap

thread pushes in from the list — +1 (917) 555-0148

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

2.4 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “...and crumbling to the ground” — deleted; a bolder one

Backspaces every character, then tries again, bolder.

ON SCREEN

BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “So when can I see you again. Tomorrow?”

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

rapid delete clicks

2.5 SL · JAMIE — “And my grandfather’s rolling...” — that one goes too; phone away

Deleted — failing to write a text on a sidewalk. He pockets the phone: black, SEPTEMBER 2021 holds center while he sings.

ON SCREEN

BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

LOCK CLOCK — 11:41

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.7 s)

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

hard black

SOUND

rapid delete clicks

room tone out

2.6 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “...with the phone in my hand” — it comes back out

The thread again. 11:47.

ON SCREEN

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 10:42 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight”

LOCK CLOCK — 11:47

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen
cut to Messages (instant)

2.7 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “Like an idiot, scared to death” — he finally sends it

Two words: “home safe?” — typed and SENT. The finale receives this exact text at 11:48.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 11:48

thread caption: · 11:48 PM

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “home safe?”

SEND — the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

delivery status: Delivered

PLAYS

sound: key clicks
sound: send swoosh

SOUND

send whoosh
keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

2.8 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “I’ve been wand’ring through the desert!” — her typing bubble

Her typing bubble appears — and stays up.

ON SCREEN

typing indicator rises (three dots)

2.9 SL · JAMIE · Phone — “If you had a pierced tongue” — he is ON THE PHONE with Cathy

The bubble never resolves as a text — she called instead. Connected call, her number on his screen; the timer ticks.

ON SCREEN

CALL SCREEN — +1 (917) 555-0148 · incoming call · incoming

call state → connected · 00:14

SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES SL = Phone · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:48

2.10 SL · JAMIE — “...waiting for someone like—” (cut off) — HE HANGS UP; phone away

Call Ended, then black — SEPTEMBER 2021 holds center. Nothing else until See I’m Smiling.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

3 · See I'm Smiling BOTH SING · 10 FIRES

NEARLY EMPTY, BY DESIGN. One post and its climbing likes are the whole birthday; the screens stay black while she sings. Then his 2021 calls cut in — the agency cold call, the callback, and Rob (an outgoing dial, per the script) — and the house learns the projections can time-travel.

3.1 BOTH · CATHY — TOP OF SEE I'M SMILING — the first chord (the pier)

No phone for her, by direction. Time rolls FORWARD center-stage — SEPTEMBER 2021 → JULY 2025, her birthday in Ohio — and holds while she sings.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

LOCK CLOCK — 6:12 · Saturday, July 19, 2025

STAMP → "JULY 2025 · OHIO"

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

3.2 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — "And you're mine... We're doing fine." — JAMIE DIALS. Time snaps back.

HIS phone, 2021 — a cold call to the agent, via Dr. Adler. He saved the office number from Adler's text as "Ms. Whitfield (office)". Time rolls BACK to SEPTEMBER 2021.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 2:41 · Tuesday, September 7, 2021

STAMP → "SEPTEMBER 2021"

CALL SCREEN — Ms. Whitfield (office) · calling... · outgoing

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES BOTH = Phone · stamp "SEPTEMBER 2021" · clock 2:41

3.3 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — JAMIE: "Hi, I'm calling for Ms. Whitfield" — it connects

Connected — the timer ticks while the conversation runs.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 00:08

3.4 BOTH · JAMIE — JAMIE: "What's your address?" — his last words; he hangs up

Call Ended; the phone goes. Time ROLLS FORWARD home, center-stage — SEPTEMBER 2021 → JULY 2025.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

LOCK CLOCK — 6:31 · Saturday, July 19, 2025

STAMP → "JULY 2025 · OHIO"

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

3.5 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *“It’s all right — We’ll have tonight.” — the agent calls HIM back*
 HIS phone again, 2021 — two weeks later (script): an INCOMING call from Ms. Whitfield. Time rolls BACK.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 4:18 · Tuesday, September 21, 2021

STAMP → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

CALL SCREEN — Ms. Whitfield (office) · incoming call · incoming

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES BOTH = Phone · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 4:18

3.6 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *JAMIE: “Hello? This is... Oh, Ms. Whitfield” — he answers*
 Connected. It runs until the thank-you.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 00:21

3.7 BOTH · JAMIE — *JAMIE: “Thank you, this is great.” — it ends*

Again: Call Ended, the phone goes, the centered timeline rolls FORWARD to her evening.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

LOCK CLOCK — 6:47 · Saturday, July 19, 2025

STAMP → “JULY 2025 · OHIO”

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

3.8 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *“And not do anything at all...” — JAMIE DIALS ROB*

SCRIPT: he dials — “perplexed but not unhappy.” The lease is up; an apartment WITH Cathy. 2021, pre-move-in. Time rolls BACK.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 8:02 · Thursday, September 30, 2021

STAMP → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

CALL SCREEN — Rob · calling mobile... · outgoing

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES BOTH = Phone · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 8:02

3.9 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *JAMIE: “Rob? Yeah, listen.” — Rob picks up*

Connected — visible through the very end of the vamp.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 01:02

3.10 BOTH · JAMIE — *DOWNBEAT OF MOVING TOO FAST* — *he hangs up*

Call Ended on the downbeat; time rolls one month FORWARD into Moving Too Fast — OCTOBER 2021, center-stage.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

LOCK CLOCK — 2:14 · Friday, October 8, 2021

STAMP → "OCTOBER 2021"

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

4 · Moving Too Fast BOTH SING · 9 FIRES

THE AVALANCHE, COMPRESSED. Her one professional call, politely deflected — then his lock screen wins five times in the exact order he sings them: the apartment, the Atlantic, the money, Columbia, Sonny. The happy infrastructure of the marriage installs itself so the back half can dismantle it.

4.1 BOTH · CATHY · Phone — *“But oh, oh — what else am I s’posed to do?” — CATHY DIALS*

HER phone — MAY 2025 (pinned by David: her backward line, between the pier and the party). Time ROLLS FORWARD from his October 2021 as she cuts in. Dialing Mike Stelmyer; his agency is never named (script).

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 10:10 · Friday, May 9, 2025

STAMP → “MAY 2025”

CALL SCREEN — Mike Stelmyer · calling... · outgoing

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES BOTH = Phone · stamp “MAY 2025” · clock 10:10

4.2 BOTH · CATHY · Phone — *END OF “...what else am I s’posed to do?” — it connects; she speaks next*

We see the dial AND the connect; the timer ticks under her call.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 00:15

4.3 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — *CATHY: “I’ll call you soon!” — the call ends; back to HIS phone*

Call Ended; time ROLLS BACK, May 2025 → October 2021 — his phone, locked, ready for the run of wins.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 2:14 · Friday, October 8, 2021

STAMP → “OCTOBER 2021”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “OCTOBER 2021” · clock 2:14

4.4 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — *“Found an apartment on Seventy-Third!”*

Move-in day pops up, both names on the day.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Calendar · MOVE-IN DAY 🚚 — W 73rd St (now): “Saturday, Oct 16 · 9:00 AM · with Cathy Hiatt”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.5 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — *“The Atlantic Monthly’s printing my first chapter”*

The Atlantic says yes.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Mail · The Atlantic Monthly (now): “We are delighted to publish your excerpt”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.6 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — *“Two thousand bucks without rewriting one word!”*

The deposit lands.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Chase (now): “You received a deposit of \$2,000.00”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.7 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — *“I left Columbia and don’t regret it”*

The withdrawal confirmation.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Mail · Columbia University (now): “Withdrawal processed – Fall term ✓”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.8 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — *“I wrote a book and Sonny Mehta read it!”*

THE BIGGEST HIT.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Linda Whitfield (now): “SONNY READ IT. CALL ME NOW.”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.9 BOTH · JAMIE — *FINAL CHORD* — *the last hit of Moving Too Fast*

Black. OCTOBER 2021 holds center until her song rolls it forward.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

5 · I’m a Part of That CATHY SINGS · 3 FIRES

HIS SILENCE, FROM HER SIDE. The party album has her as “and guest”; the repost crops her out; her texts sit Not Delivered under six hours of his Do Not Disturb. The 6:04 release — everything flips Delivered at once — is the quiet center of the song. Then a stranger’s photo of the dedication page.

5.1 SR · CATHY — *TOP OF I’M A PART OF THAT* — *the first notes of the intro*

Time rolls FORWARD center-stage — OCTOBER 2021 → MARCH 2025, the book party — and holds while she sings.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

LOCK CLOCK — 8:12 · Saturday, March 8, 2025

STAMP → “MARCH 2025”

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

5.2 SR · CATHY · books — *“I’m a part of that.”* — *THE LAST TIME she sings it, as she picks up the book*

The one thing this song needs. Her phone: unlock, Books — his novel opens where she left it, the last page. The dedication: “For Cathy.” The last image of the song.

ON SCREEN

BOOKS — his novel, open on her phone: “For Cathy” · 312 of 312

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Books — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SR = books · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 8:12

HOLD · *Script direction: she looks briefly at the dedication page, then closes the book. Let the page sit through the final chord.*

5.3 SR · CATHY — *FINAL CHORD* — *the last note of the song*

Black. MARCH 2025 holds center.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

6 · The Schmuel Song **JAMIE SINGS · 2 FIRES**

STILLNESS, BY DIRECTION. One held Christmas image. No animation, no cueing inside the number — the kindest screen of the night, deliberately so; the generosity buys the betrayal its full price later. Not one Elise pixel anywhere in this song.

6.1 **SL · JAMIE · Lock screen** — *TOP OF THE SCHMUEL SONG* — *the tree lights come up, before he speaks*

His phone, locked — the Christmas wallpaper (M23). Time rolls BACK, MARCH 2025 → DECEMBER 2022. No animations: the phone keeps the season for the whole song.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 9:12 · Saturday, December 24, 2022

STAMP → “DECEMBER 2022”

WALLPAPER — M23 — Christmas tree lights

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES **SL** = Lock screen · stamp “DECEMBER 2022” · clock 9:12

6.2 **SL · JAMIE** — *FINAL CHORD* — *after the watch, the last note*

Black. DECEMBER 2022 holds center.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

7 · A Summer in Ohio CATHY SINGS · 3 FIRES

ONE CUE. The prerecorded FaceTime (V2) carries the entire number — Jamie at his desk, half-attending, writing, while Ohio sings to him. The engine draws only the FaceTime frame and the call chrome; everything alive in it is the video.

7.1 SR · CATHY · FaceTime — *TOP OF A SUMMER IN OHIO — the intro vamp; she places the call*

Cathy's laptop, Ohio — time rolls FORWARD, DECEMBER 2022 → JUNE 2024. She places the FaceTime call: the RINGING screen, his initial pulsing, no video yet.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 9:38 · Friday, June 21, 2024

STAMP → "JUNE 2024 · OHIO"

FACETIME — Jamie · FaceTime...

PLAYS

the MacBook shell appears — CATHY's screen

SOUND

FaceTime trill, then connect pop

PHONES SR = FaceTime · stamp "JUNE 2024 · OHIO" · clock 9:38

7.2 SR · CATHY · FaceTime — *"I could have a mansion on a hill" — her first line; HE ANSWERS*

He answers. The prerecorded FaceTime (V2) plays for the entire number — only Jamie, no Cathy self-view — with the real FaceTime overlays and a ticking call duration.

ON SCREEN

FaceTime state → connected

HOLD · *Nothing else to fire until the final chord. The video carries the number.*

7.3 SR · CATHY — *FINAL CHORD — the last note; the call ends and she closes the laptop*

Call Ended card (his initial dimmed), a breath, then the screen goes — JUNE 2024 holds center until the wedding rolls it.

ON SCREEN

FaceTime state → Call Ended

... a beat (auto-timed, 2.6 s)

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

8 · The Next Ten Minutes BOTH SING · 4 FIRES

TIME, NOT CONTENT. The phones mark only where we are: June 12, 2023 — then the one date both timelines share, enormous: MAY 18, 2024 — then back again on the rowboat line. The era rail does the traveling; the people do the vows.

8.1 BOTH · CATHY · Lock screen — JAMIE: “No, that one’s Jerry Seinfeld” — his first line, in the rowboat

No animations, by direction: the phones only mark WHERE WE ARE IN TIME. Her phone, locked — the engagement day, June 12, 2023 — time rolls BACK from Ohio 2024.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 4:44 · Monday, June 12, 2023

STAMP → “JUNE 2023”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 2023” · clock 4:44

8.2 BOTH · CATHY · Lock screen — JAMIE: “For the next ten lifetimes?” — the altar

The only date both timelines will ever share — the lock screen rolls FORWARD to Saturday, May 18, 2024.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 6:47 · Saturday, May 18, 2024

STAMP → “MAY 2024 · THE WEDDING”

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “MAY 2024 · THE WEDDING” · clock 6:47

8.3 BOTH · CATHY · Lock screen — CATHY: “Is that one John Lennon?” — back in the boat

The clock rolls BACK to the beginning of the piece.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 4:44 · Monday, June 12, 2023

STAMP → “JUNE 2023”

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 2023” · clock 4:44

8.4 BOTH · CATHY — FINAL CHORD — the lights fade on the boat. END OF ACT ONE

INTERMISSION card. It holds through the break; the first GO of Act Two (9.1) clears it.

ON SCREEN

INTERMISSION CARD — the house sees “Intermission”; it holds until Act Two’s first GO

9 · A Miracle Would Happen JAMIE SINGS · 7 FIRES

NOTIFICATIONS ONLY. His married year arrives as a stack he never touches — readers, the growing book, Elise, front row. The phone will not stop, and he never once interacts with it. The attention just lands.

9.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *TOP OF ACT TWO — the first notes of the vamp, before he sings*

The Intermission card goes. His phone, locked — time rolls FORWARD, JUNE 2023 → OCTOBER 2024. Married, at a party, and the phone will not stop. He never touches it; the attention just arrives.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 11:22 · Friday, October 18, 2024

STAMP → “OCTOBER 2024”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “OCTOBER 2024” · clock 11:22

9.2 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “...suddenly finds you attractive”

A reader.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Instagram · @a.reader.somewhere (now): “okay the ending WRECKED me. how are you real”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.3 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “And now they’re banging down your door”

And another.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Instagram · @lit.with.lena (now): “sent you a message request”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.4 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “I’m the grand fromage”

The book keeps growing without him.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Goodreads (now): “Your book passed 10,000 ratings · ★ 4.6”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.5 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “Let’s get a cup of coffee.” — Elise

And Elise.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Elise · Ed. (now): “proofs went out 🥳 celebratory drink sometime?”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.6 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “It’s a challenge to resist temptation” — *THE SECOND TIME (after the party)*

Front row.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Instagram · @novel.annie (now): “front row at your reading tonight 📖”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.7 SL · JAMIE — *FINAL CHORD* — *the last note of the song*

Black. OCTOBER 2024 holds center.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

10 · Climbing Uphill CATHY SINGS · 6 FIRES

HER INTERIOR VS. HIS SCROLL. The bell-tone fragments rhyme with the sung monologue and never transcribe it — protect that rule in every edit.

10.1 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — TOP OF CLIMBING UPHILL — the intro, before her first note

Her phone, locked, in the audition hallway — time rolls BACK, OCTOBER 2024 → FEBRUARY 2024. An older sign-in reminder sits on the lock screen; then his text lands on top: “break a leg” — lowercase, three seconds of effort.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 9:52 · Monday, February 5, 2024

STAMP → “FEBRUARY 2024”

NOTIFICATION — Mail · Casting Networks (8:14 AM): “Reminder: sign-in opens 10:00 AM — Equity chorus call”

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.1 s)

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Jamie ❤️ (now): “break a leg”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

PHONES SR = Lock screen · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 9:52

10.2 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — CATHY: “Okay, thank you. Thank you so much.” — her first spoken line

A rejection lands over the lock screen — last week’s audition, answered. Just enough to read: they are not moving forward.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Mail · Meridian Stage Company – Casting (now): “Thank you for auditioning. We will not be moving forward at this time, but we hope to see you...”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

10.3 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — “Belting as high as they can!”

Another one. A callback that went the other way.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Mail · Northfield Summer Playhouse (now): “Re: your callback — we have decided to go in another direction. We will keep your...”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

10.4 SR · CATHY — “Grant me Grace!” — she puts the phone away

Black — FEBRUARY 2024 holds center while she sings.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

10.5 SR · CATHY · Messages — *THE BELL TONE* — *before the audition where we hear her thoughts*

FLASHBACK, AUTO-PLAYS from this GO. Time rolls BACK three months, FEBRUARY 2024 → NOVEMBER 2023. Her phone lights: a text from him, long and thoughtful — the night before an earlier callback. She opens it; the thread shows the man he was three months ago.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

LOCK CLOCK — 9:48 · Wednesday, November 8, 2023

STAMP → “NOVEMBER 2023”

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.6 s)

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Jamie ❤️ (now): “You are going to walk in there tomorrow and be the best thing they see all week. I mean it. Whatever happens in that room, you are already the real thing — I have known that since the first night. Go get it, and call me the second you are out. I love you.”

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.8 s)

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— Tuesday · 8:15 PM

SENT (blue): “callback thursday. 9am. help”

RECEIVED (gray): “you’ve got this. what are you singing?”

SENT (blue): “the one you like”

— Today · 9:48 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “You are going to walk in there tomorrow and be the best thing they see all week. I mean it. Whatever happens in that room, you are already the real thing — I have known that since the first night. Go get it, and call me the second you are out. I love you.”

PLAYS

hard black

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

sound: receive ding

TAP THE NOTIFICATION — a beat on the banner, Face ID passes, and the app opens DIRECTLY onto Messages. One motion.

No home screen. (No touch dot anywhere in the show — cut by direction; the screen’s own feedback carries every tap.)

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

tap thock

room tone out

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp “NOVEMBER 2023” · clock 9:48

HOLD · *The contrast IS the cue: three seconds of effort in February, a paragraph in November.*

10.6 SR · CATHY — JAMIE: “Cathy, what are you doing now?” — *his phone scene begins*

The phone goes; time rolls FORWARD home — NOVEMBER 2023 → FEBRUARY 2024 — and holds center to the end of the song.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

LOCK CLOCK — 9:52 · Monday, February 5, 2024

STAMP → “FEBRUARY 2024”

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

11 · If I Didn't Believe In You JAMIE SINGS · 1 FIRES

THE FIGHT HAS AN AUDIENCE: HIS PHONE. What the argument is actually about sits unsigned on the other side of the stage all song.

11.1 SL · JAMIE — *JAMIE: “Okay, stop. Cathy, stop.” — his first words*

Timeline only, by direction. Time rolls FORWARD center-stage — FEBRUARY 2024 → MARCH 2026, the night of the party — and holds for the whole song.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

LOCK CLOCK — 7:41 · Friday, March 6, 2026

STAMP → “MARCH 2026”

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

12 · I Can Do Better Than That CATHY SINGS · 2 FIRES

HER GHOST REGISTER, USED FOR LOVE. Drafted courage, kept receipts, a shared playlist — the exact mirror of what his register becomes.

12.1 SR · CATHY · `mapsdrive` — *TOP OF I CAN DO BETTER THAN THAT* — *the first note of the vamp*

Her phone on the dash — Apple Maps, mid-route, New York → the Eastern Shore. Time rolls BACK, MARCH 2026 → NOVEMBER 2021. The drive really moves for the whole song: the puck rides the route, the miles and minutes fall, each maneuver counts down, and the phone's clock runs 4:05 → 7:45. Arrival lands five minutes after this GO.

ON SCREEN

MAPS — THE DRIVE (live, time-based from this GO): St. Michaels — the Eastern Shore · arrival in 5 min of stage time

compressed trip: 220 min / 214 mi · the puck rides the route, maneuvers count down, the phone clock runs with it

LOCK CLOCK — 4:05 · Saturday, November 6, 2021

STAMP → "NOVEMBER 2021"

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY's screen

PHONES SR = `mapsdrive` · stamp "NOVEMBER 2021" · clock 4:05

HOLD · ``dur`` (seconds to arrival) lives on this cue in `cues.js` — match it to the song in tech. After arrival the screen holds on "You have arrived."

12.2 SR · CATHY — *FINAL CHORD* — *the last note of the song*

Black. NOVEMBER 2021 holds center.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

13 · Nobody Needs to Know JAMIE SINGS · 3 FIRES

THE PAYOFF. The same three gestures as the first night, frozen over. Speed that read as charm now reads as practice.

13.1 SL · JAMIE — *TOP OF NOBODY NEEDS TO KNOW* — *the first note, before he sings*

Time rolls FORWARD center-stage — NOVEMBER 2021 → JUNE 2026, before dawn. His phone is face-down somewhere it should not be.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

LOCK CLOCK — 6:12 · Thursday, June 11, 2026

STAMP → “JUNE 2026”

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

13.2 SL · JAMIE — “Cathy is waiting” — *her text lands*

AUTO-PLAYS from this GO. His phone lights on the nightstand — 9% battery — with her good-morning text. He swipes it away immediately, unread, and the screen goes dark again. JUNE 2026 holds.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Cathy 🍷 (now): “good morning. can’t wait to see you — what time does your flight land?”

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.5 s)

notification SWIPED AWAY — slides off and is gone

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.9 s)

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

sound: receive ding

hard black

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

room tone out

13.3 SL · JAMIE · findmy — “...in love with someone like you” — his last line; *Find My*, location back ON

Unlock, Find My, her card — she is in Ohio, and he has not been sharing back. Share My Location → Share Indefinitely. The green check is the last image of the song: the cover-up, filed as devotion.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 6:31

FIND MY — her card: Cathy 🧡 · Medina, OH · [Share My Location] (blue)

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.8 s)

FINGER RESTS ON [Share My Location] — the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

ACTION SHEET slides up over the app — “Share your location with Cathy 🧡?”

buttons: [Share for One Hour] · [Share Until End of Day] · [Share Indefinitely] · [Cancel]

FINGER RESTS ON [Share Indefinitely] — the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

PRESSES [Share Indefinitely]

FIND MY — her card: Cathy 🧡 · Medina, OH · Sharing My Location ✓ Indefinitely (green) ·

[Stop Sharing My Location] (red)

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS FindMy — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = findmy · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 6:31

HOLD · *Location was OFF before the song (we never see him turn it off). Hold on this screen through the final chord; 14.1 takes it away.*

14 · Goodbye Until Tomorrow / I Could Never Rescue You **BOTH**

SING · 6 FIRES

THE GRAMMAR RESOLVES. Her firsts fill as his lasts empty — the same thread from both ends, five years apart.

14.1 **BOTH · CATHY** — *TOP OF THE FINALE* — *the intro, before her first line*

The phone goes; time rolls BACK center-stage — JUNE 2026 → SEPTEMBER 2021, the first night — and holds while she sings.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

LOCK CLOCK — 11:40 · Friday, September 3, 2021

STAMP → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

14.2 **BOTH · CATHY** — *JAMIE: “I called Elise to help me pack my bags”* — *his first line*

His half: time rolls FORWARD, SEPTEMBER 2021 → JUNE 2026, his last afternoon.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 2:40 · Thursday, June 11, 2026

STAMP → “JUNE 2026”

14.3 **BOTH · CATHY** — *CATHY: “Goodbye until I crawl to your door”* — *her return*

Back to her: time rolls BACK to the first night.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 11:47 · Friday, September 3, 2021

STAMP → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

14.4 BOTH · CATHY · Messages — CATHY: “I will be waiting for you!” — her LAST line before he stands; his text lands

THE ONE ANIMATION. Her phone lights on the steps: “home safe?” — the text the house watched him send in Shiksa Goddess. She opens it and starts to answer. SHE IS STILL TYPING when his last verse takes the stage.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 11:48

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Jamie (now): “home safe?”

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.5 s)

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 10:42 PM

SENT (blue): “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight”

— Today · 11:48 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “home safe?”

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.5 s)

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “safe 😊 tonight was”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

sound: receive ding

TAP THE NOTIFICATION — a beat on the banner, Face ID passes, and the app opens DIRECTLY onto Messages. One motion.

No home screen. (No touch dot anywhere in the show — cut by direction; the screen’s own feedback carries every tap.)

sound: key clicks

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

tap thock

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

PHONES BOTH = Messages · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:48

HOLD · *Do not send. It is the payoff of Shiksa Goddess, two hours ago.*

14.5 BOTH · CATHY — JAMIE: “You never noticed how the wind had changed” — he stands

The phone goes mid-word. Time rolls FORWARD to JUNE 2026 — the breakup — and holds as the last image while he sings his goodbye.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

LOCK CLOCK — 4:12 · Thursday, June 11, 2026

STAMP → “JUNE 2026”

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

HOLD · *Hold it. Do not resolve it.*

14.6 BOTH · CATHY — FINAL BLACKOUT — on the last “Goodbye”

True black. End of show.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “”

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out